Ethel Bokani Dumulomo Jena, BIS

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Professional Summary

Operations and safety management professional with 14+ years of experience supporting the United States Peace Corps South Africa. Experienced in coordinating administrative systems, implementing safety and operational policies, and supporting cross-department collaboration to ensure effective program delivery.

Known for strong organizational leadership, training coordination, risk assessment, and data-driven reporting. Trusted partner to staff, volunteers, and leadership in maintaining operational standards, compliance, and a safe working environment.

Core Competencies

Operations Coordination, Policy Implementation & Compliance, Administrative Systems Management Staff Training & Development, Risk Assessment & Incident Management, Stakeholder & Interagency, Coordination, Operational Reporting & Data Analysis, Crisis Response & Safety Planning Cross-Cultural Communication

Professional Experience

United States Peace Corps - South Africa (June 2011 – Present)

Safety & Security Manager (current)
/ Volunteer Support Specialist / Sexual Assault Response Liaison / Health Program Assistant

- Support implementation of Peace Corps safety and security policies and maintain operational systems that ensure volunteer safety in accordance with Peace Corps Manual Section 270.
- Manage the Volunteer Information Database (VIDA) site locator system, ensuring accurate tracking of volunteer locations and site information.
- Collaborate with programming staff to develop and maintain site selection protocols and documentation for volunteer placements.
- Coordinate safety and security training sessions during Pre-Service Training (PST) and In-Service Training (IST) in partnership with training and program leadership.
- Conduct site visits and safety assessments to evaluate risks and recommend mitigation strategies for volunteer housing and communities.
- Analyze annual crime trends and provide reports to leadership and the Peace Corps Office of Safety and Security to inform program improvements.
- Provide confidential, trauma-informed support and response coordination for volunteers affected by sexual assault or harassment.
- Lead prevention and awareness initiatives and was recognized in 2023 for 10 years of service supporting volunteer safety.

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Research Triangle Institute (RTI) International - South Africa

Office Manager (November 2007 – May 2011)

- Managed administrative operations supporting USAID-funded development programs including PEPFAR and Women's Justice & Empowerment initiatives.
- Coordinated project reporting, budgeting support, and operational logistics across multiple field programs.
- Conducted monitoring visits to program sites and supported coordination with government agencies and USAID stakeholders.
- Collaborated with the National Prosecuting Authority on justice and community safety initiatives.

National Blood Service - Southern Africa

Executive Coordinator (1998 – October 2007)

- Provided executive administrative and operational support within a national health organization working with international partners.
- Coordinated strategic planning activities, executive communications, and operational reporting.
- Supported policy implementation and stakeholder coordination with regional and international health organizations.

Education

- Bachelor of Interdisciplinary Studies (Business Management, Public Health, Psychology) – Brigham Young University, Idaho
- Associate of Science, General Studies – Brigham Young University, Idaho

Certifications

- Certificate, Occupational Safety & Health
- Certificate, Health Program Evaluation
- Certificate, Business Fundamentals and Leadership Skills
- Postgraduate Certificate, Finance Management for Non-Financial Managers – Univ. of Pretoria
- Certificate in Auditing – London Chamber of Commerce & Industry
- Diploma, Business Management & Administration – British College of Prof. Management

Professional Training

- Sexual Assault Risk Reduction & Response Training
- ISO 9001:2000 Quality Awareness
- Strategic Planning & Organizational Development
- Project Design & Management
- International Computer Driver's License (ICDL)